

Lab Session 01

Portfolio Wireframe

This session is designed for newbies to Figma, aiming to equip you with the basic skills to create a rough wireframe of a portfolio website.

All shortcuts are macOS. For shortcuts on your OS click the black & white question mark on the bottom right of Figma and select "Keyboard shortcuts".

Session Outline

- **Introduction to Figma (10 mins)**
 - What is Figma?
 - Why use Figma for wireframing?
- **Create an account (5 mins)**
- **Figma UI Overview (10 mins)**
 - Layers Panel (left)
 - Canvas (center)
 - Toolbar (bottom)
 - Properties Panel (right)
- **Navigation & Basic Interactions (10 mins)**
 - Zooming (CMD + Mousewheel)
 - Panning (Spacebar)
 - Selecting objects
 - CMD + Click: Select through layers
 - Lock aspect ratio when resizing: Shift
 - Show Measurements: Alt
 - Hide UI: CMD + .
 - Moving objects
 - Duplicate objects: Alt + Click & Drag
- **Creating Basic Shapes (10mins)**
 - Rectangle tool (R key)
 - Resizing
 - Color fill
 - Borders
- **Adding Text (5 mins)**
 - Text tool (T key)
 - Typing text
 - Basic text styling (font size, bold)
- **Organize Artboards (5 mins)**

- Pages
- Frames (Artboards)
 - 1440 x 800 as a good measure
- Sections
- **Drawing session (10 mins)**
 - Draw your portfolio in 2 minutes
 - When you have no time → reduce to the essence
 - similar to elevator pitches
 - scientific work <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=45313557>
 - Iterate to get basic blocks
- **Building a Rough Portfolio Wireframe (15 mins)**
 - Header (logo placeholder, navigation links)
 - Hero section (image placeholder, headline, call to action)
 - About section (text placeholder, image placeholder)
 - Projects section (multiple rectangle placeholders, text placeholders)
 - Footer (contact info placeholder)
- **Hand-in (5 mins)**
 - Export as local copy
- **Useful Shortcuts (5 mins)**
 - Command Palette (CMD + K)
 - Duplicate (Cmd/Ctrl + D)
 - Group (Cmd/Ctrl + G)
 - Ungroup (Shift + Cmd/Ctrl + G)
 - Copy (Cmd/Ctrl + C)
 - Paste (Cmd/Ctrl + V)
 - Show / hide layout guides (Shift + G)
- **Q&A and Next Steps (10 mins)**